

2026 EXHIBITOR & SPONSOR PACK



Where ambitious founders meet the partners who help them scale.

5000+ Visitors

200 Speakers

4 Stages

150 Exhibitors

nec
Birmingham

**3-4 November
2026**

Built for founders who run growing businesses.



The audience

- 2,583 attended in 2025
(doubling to 5,000 in 2026)
- 83% founders or senior leaders with decision making authority
- 35% £1m+ turnover businesses
- 46% repeat founders
- National draw with 30%+ from London & South East



The intent

- 66% came to meet partners
- 47% came specifically to find technology or services
- 48% actively exploring funding
- 40% building leadership capability



The opportunity

- 150 exhibitors across funding, technology, advisory and growth services
- 50 curated meet-ups
- 5,000sqm footprint
- Year-round marketing campaign reaching 500,000+ founders

**They come to learn from entrepreneurs who've done it
— and meet the partners they'll work with next.**



Entrepreneurship is the UK's growth engine

The Festival is the event that brings together those who build, those who back, and those who accelerate growth.

The Festival of Entrepreneurs has already established itself as the UK's serious platform for scaling founders — an event that combines ambition with real substance.

In 2025 we saw plenty of full stages, engaged audiences and genuine enthusiasm from the entrepreneurial community. It showed how quickly progress happens when founders meet the people who can support their next stage of growth.

Our focus now is to build on that success with care and intention. Expanding the event, growing the attendance, refining the content and creating new networking opportunities to increase the depth of conversation and the quality of connections.

We proved the model, the audience and the need. Now we're scaling it with precision, purpose and quality.

The Rt Hon Sir Liam Fox
Chair
Festival of Entrepreneurs



A proven event model designed to deliver commercial outcomes.

For exhibitors and sponsors, that means meeting decision-makers. Founders with revenue, teams and plans

The Festival of Entrepreneurs was built with a clear purpose — to create a collegiate environment where founders can access the insight, expertise and solutions that help them grow. The result is an event model that works for visitors and for the organisations who support them.

They attend to explore funding, technology, marketing, talent and operational tools, creating a commercially focused atmosphere where discussions quickly turn into next steps.

In 2026, the Festival expands to 5,000 square metres, welcoming 5,000 visitors, 150 exhibitors and 200 speakers, with four stages and three networking zones hosting structured meet-ups throughout both days.

James Ashwood

Founder

Festival of Entrepreneurs



2025 – who came? A commercially serious audience of ambitious founders

The inaugural 2025 Festival of Entrepreneurs attracted an attendance of 2583. These were entrepreneurs who are building real businesses. They are commercially minded, growth-focused and ready to invest in the partners who can help them move faster.

Seniority & Role	%	Geography	%	Entrepreneurial Experience	%
Founder, Co-Founder, Owner	61	West Midlands	32	First-time Founder	54
C-Suite, Senior Leadership	22	London	18	Second-time Founder	24
Director, Head of Function	8	South East	14	Third-time Founder	11
Manager, Team Lead	5	East Midlands	12	Fourth-time Founder	5
Consultant, Advisor, Investor	2	South West	6	Fifth or more	6
Other	2	North West	6		
		Yorkshire & North East	5		
		East of England	4		
		Scotland, Wales & N. Ireland	3		
Company Size (Employees)	%	Turnover (£)	%		
1 – 5	41	Up to £1m	65		
6 – 20	28	£1m – £5m	19		
21 – 50	18	£5m – £10m	10		
50 – 200	9	£10m +	6		
200 +	4				



High-intent founders with clear goals

Attendees come with defined commercial goals — to form partnerships, secure funding and find the tools that drive growth. They're active decision-makers investing in products, services and relationships that move their

What they came to do*

- 66 % to meet partners and collaborators
- 54 % to learn how entrepreneurs scaled
- 50 % to keep up with trends and innovation
- 48 % to connect with investors or funding platforms
- 47 % to find technology or services to support growth
- 44 % to understand how to scale faster
- 41 % to meet founders at a similar stage
- 40 % to build team or leadership capability

Funding profile

68 % revenue-funded, with additional cohorts using Start-Up Loans, commercial debt, angels and institutional investment.

Nearly half (47%) are exploring new funding — a financially mature audience with real traction and clear appetite for growth capital.



*multiple selections allowed

Highlights of the 2025 Keynote stage



Sir Liam Fox Chair Festival, **Louis Taylor** CBE CEO British Business Bank, **Irene Graham** OBE CEO Scale up Institute, **Anthony Impey** CEO Be the Business, **Ian O'Donnell** MBE Director FSB



Alex Chisnal Co-Founder Festival, **Rownea Bird** Co-Founder LUSH Cosmetics



Sir Richard Harpin Founder HomeServe



Boris Diakonov Founder ANNA, **Jo Dalton** Founder JD&Co, **Dom McGregor** Co-Founder Social Chain



Piers Linney MBE Co-Founder Implement AI (Former BBC Dragon)



Mark Rushmore Co-Founder SURI toothbrush, **Claire Warner** Founder Æcorndrinks, **Laura Fullerton** Founder Monk

Headline founders and nationally recognised operators



Catalina Valentino Co-Founder & CEO elixr, **Jeanette Linfoot** Founder Brave Bold Brilliant



Juliett Barratt Co-Founder Grenade



Ray Kelvin CBE Founder Ted Baker



Darcy Laceby Co-Founder Absolute Collagen, **Maxine Laceby** Co-Founder Absolute Collagen



Heba Bevan OBE Founder Utterberry, **Raj Thiruchelvarjah** Founder Hytro, **Rebecca Drew** CEO Vistage



Daniel Elahi Founder Revival Shots, **Sabrina Stocker** Founder 2 Comma PR, **Tre Lowe** Founder Sobo (all former BBC Apprentice)

Who was involved in 2025?

The sponsors, exhibitors, partners and speakers who founded or represent the following organisations





Whats next for 2026?

Expanding the space, the audience and the commercial opportunity.

A larger footprint, more founders, more exhibitors creating a stronger platform for growth.

The 2026 Festival will expand to 5,000+ founders, leaders and partners, following a successful debut attended by more than 2,500. The increased footprint and wider national marketing campaign will attract new audiences from across the UK, creating greater commercial opportunity for exhibitors and sponsors.

A broader exhibitor mix

The 2026 show floor will feature a broader mix of growth solutions — banks and lenders, funding and fintech platforms, advisory, accountancy and legal services, technology and IT partners, SaaS and automation tools, HR, recruitment and leadership development, marketing, brand and digital growth specialists — attracting visitors with stronger buying intent and wider needs.

Networking re-imagined

Networking is being transformed. Across the two days, 50 themed, hour-long meet-ups will be curated so visitors, exhibitors and speakers can connect around shared interests.





Four stages designed for thought leadership, influence and commercial engagement.

A content programme that attracts serious founders — and creates valuable opportunities for sponsors and exhibitors to lead the conversation.

The Festival's content is one of its defining strengths. Each stage is programmed to attract founders who want practical insight from people with real experience. For partners, it offers a platform to demonstrate expertise, shape discussion and generate high-quality leads through session participation and visibility.

Speaking, hosting or aligning with a stage gives brands direct access to audiences who have chosen sessions based on their growth priorities — and attendance data is shared, enabling precise follow-up and measurable return.

1. Keynote Stage

Sessions led by founders who have built nationally recognised brands.

Ideal for: major sponsors, banks, national brands, leading technology companies

2. Funding Stage

Practical finance conversations covering debt, equity and alternative funding, led by those who provide it.

Ideal for: banks, lenders, fintech, advisory, accountants, investment platforms, capital providers.

3. Tech, AI & Marketing Stage

Digital tools, automation and brand growth strategies that help founders perform and scale faster.

Ideal for: software platforms, AI and automation providers, MSPs, martech, agencies, digital consultants.

4. People, Culture & Leadership Stage

Building teams, performance, mindset and culture for sustainable scale.

Ideal for: HR tech, recruitment firms, leadership development, coaching, employee platforms, workplace services.



Lead the conversation on business growth — generate sales leads with business owners who are growing

A direct route to 5,000 growth-focused founders. The Festival brings business owners together to explore funding, technology and talent — and gives exhibitors and sponsors meaningful engagement

Benefits of participating

Shape the agenda

Take part in discussions on funding, innovation, technology and leadership alongside respected founders and national business figures. Your experts can appear on stage, host workshops or feature in our podcast and article series that reach founders year-round.

Meet real decision-makers

83 % of attendees are founders or senior leaders. They come with purpose — to find solutions, partners and services that accelerate growth. Every conversation has commercial potential.



Visibility with scale and credibility

Your brand features across the Festival's integrated marketing campaign, reaching 500,000 entrepreneurs nationwide through web, email, podcast and social channels. On-site, your stand sits within a 5,000 sqm show floor designed around live content and visitor flow.

Alignment with entrepreneurial growth

The Festival champions the people driving Britain's business growth from the ground up. Partners align with a national community of founders creating jobs, building value and moving the economy forward through enterprise and innovation.

A major new feature for 2026 — 50 hosted meet-ups connecting founders, partners and experts.

Visitor and exhibitor feedback from 2025 was clear: people wanted more ways to meet each other. In response, the 2026 Festival will introduce a major new networking programme designed to increase visitor value, create structure around connections, and offer sponsors and exhibitors more ways to engage directly.

3 dedicated 'Connection hubs'

Across three dedicated networking zones, 50 hour-long, themed meet-ups will take place across both days.

Each meet-up will focus on a key growth theme from funding, marketing and technology adoption to leadership, exporting and innovation — giving hosts a natural way to demonstrate expertise and spark new relationships.



A visitor marketing campaign that reaches hundreds of thousands of entrepreneurs

Visibility at the Festival of Entrepreneurs extends well beyond the event itself. Every sponsor and exhibitor benefits from a year-round marketing campaign that engages founders before, during and after the Festival — driving awareness, leads and long-term brand recognition.

In 2025, our campaign reached more than 500,000 entrepreneurs through a targeted mix of digital, social and media activity.

Campaign highlights

Email reach

500,000+ founders and business leaders contacted through segmented outreach campaigns.

Website traffic

Averaging over 40,000 unique visits a month on the lead up (time on site +2.5mins)

LinkedIn audience

20,000+ followers across company and founder profiles, growing weekly.

Podcast & newsletter

Delivered to over 4,000 who registered for the 2025 event which will grow monthly to around 10,000 by the time 2026 registration opens 3 months before the next event

Post-event content

Recorded sessions, interviews and video clips shared daily for three months after the Festival.

Testimonials from Festival exhibitors

"I had a fantastic experience at the Festival of Entrepreneurs. It's a rare event that brings together such an open, ambitious and generous group of founders, and the energy across the day really reflected that. I left feeling inspired, with several valuable new connections and conversations that I'm confident will turn into long-term relationships."

Mark Rushmore, Co-founder of SURI

"Festival of Entrepreneurs was a fantastic event for Strategus Consulting. It was great to meet so many entrepreneurs and founders and hear their ambitions. Follow up has also been excellent, with over 85,000 people viewing our FOE related episodes of the Leaders in Strategy Podcast. We will be back in 2026 with a much bigger stand and look forward to supporting more entrepreneurs to scale up their businesses."

Mike Harris, CEO of Strategus Consulting

"We exhibited at last year's Festival of Entrepreneurs and picked up many leads for our fractional c-suite services, so this is a highly recommended event"

John Courtney, CEO of BoardroomAdvisors.co

"Our presence at the Festival of Entrepreneurs was a real standout this year. The energy around our stand was fantastic, engaging, inviting, and full of meaningful conversations with entrepreneurs, innovators, and partners who were genuinely excited about what we had to offer.

Overall, the event was a brilliant platform for us to showcase FSB. We're already looking forward to being part of it again."

Linsey Luke, Head of Business and Stakeholder Engagement, FSB

Testimonials from Festival exhibitors

"The Festival of Entrepreneurs was a great event, there was real interest in applied AI with established Founders who are scaling their businesses and we made valuable connections. We have rebooked for the next one!"

Dominic Kos, Founder of Cleverfox AI

"It was an absolute privilege to have taken part in the Festival. Superb event and looking forward to Festival of Entrepreneurs 2026.

Anthony Impey, CEO of Be the Business

"So many ideas under one roof! The Festival of Entrepreneurs 2025 brought together a diverse range of speakers and exhibitors, all providing valuable insight and encouragement to business owners and leaders."

Sara McCracken, CEO of The PR Club

"The Festival of Entrepreneurs stood out for its clarity of purpose. A well-curated room of people who are genuinely building businesses, sharing openly, and thinking long term.

It was thoughtfully run, energising to be part of, and a pleasure to contribute to a community that values momentum."

Rob Hanna, Founder & CEO of KC Partners

"The scale and energy in Festival of Entrepreneurs was fantastic, and we really appreciated the opportunity to be part of it."

Jay Lad, Business Growth West Midlands

Expanded to 5,000sqm at the NEC Birmingham. Over 40% of space already allocated

Technical details

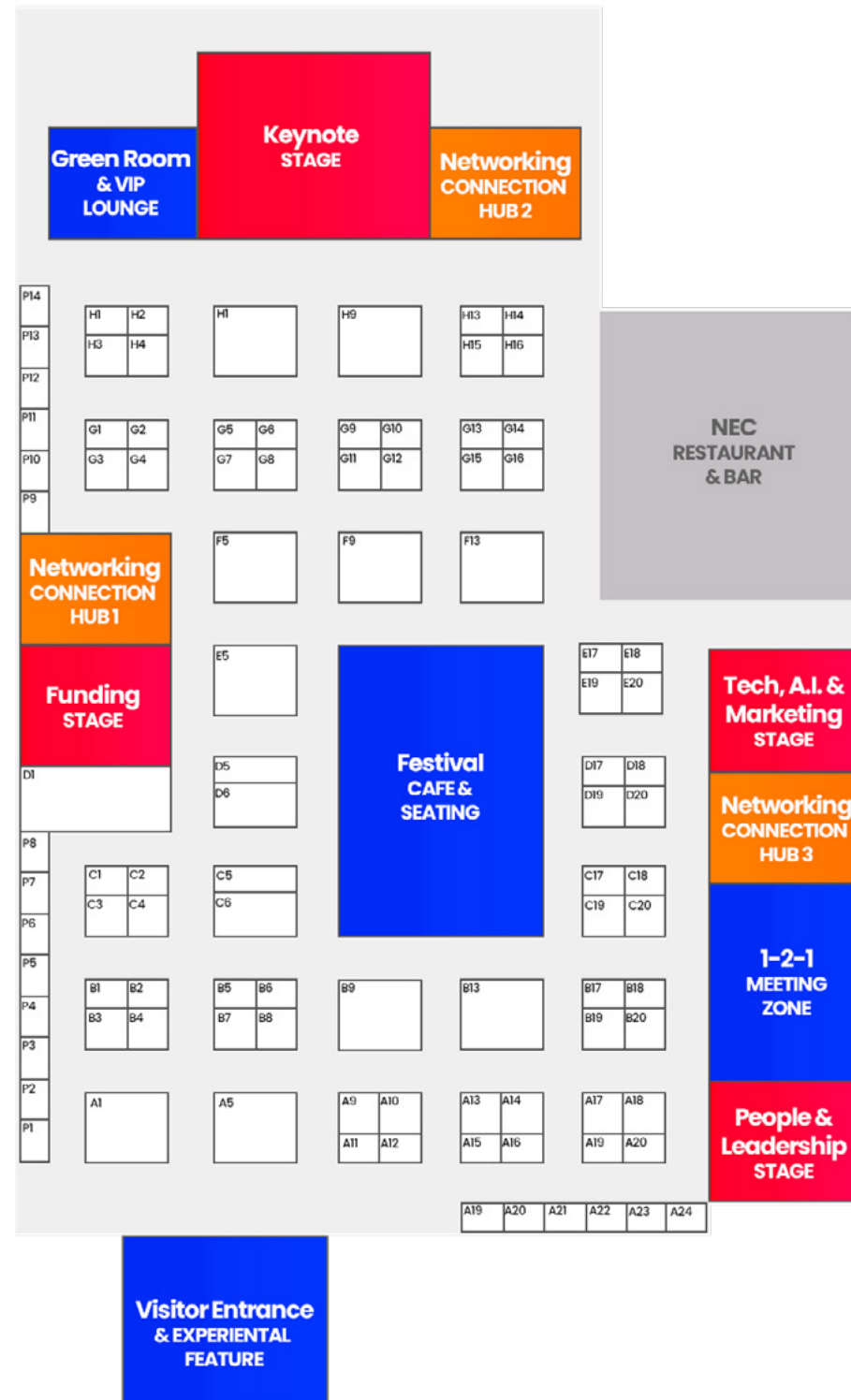
Space 5000sqm

Example stand sizes:

A1	6 x 5 (30 sqm)
B1	3 x 2 (6 sqm)
C19	3 x 3 (9 sqm)
C5	6 x 2 (12 sqm)
D6	6 x 3 (18 sqm)

Custom sizes upon request.

Space only available above 18sqm.



Exhibiting rates and options

All stand packages include two full days access to 5,000 founders and inclusion in the Festival's year-round marketing campaign.

Exhibition space

The rate per square meter (sqm) is £550.

This includes a shell scheme stand which comprises a premium black frame (2.5m high), walls, nameboard and carpets. Space only (for own constructed stands) is available on spaces 18 sqm or larger). The prices are for both days.

Rates and sizes

3m x 2m	(6sqm)	£3,300
3m x 3m	(9sqm)	£4,950
6m x 2m	(12sqm)	£6,600
6m x 3m	(18sqm)	£9,900
6m x 5m	(30sqm)	£16,500
6m x 12m	(72sqm)	£33,000

Speaker opportunity

Become an expert speaker at the Festival and benefit from a full promotional campaign, alignment with the other speakers and data of attendees.

Sponsorship opportunities

Position your brand at the centre of a national gathering of 5,000 founders and decision-makers.

The tiers below provide a framework for visibility and engagement. Final positioning, content alignment and activation details are confirmed in discussion to ensure each partnership reflects your commercial priorities and target audience.

Bronze partner £10,000

Includes: Bronze level sponsorship rights and branding
3m x 3m stand
1 x seminar (solo, workshop or arrange a panel)
Digital marketing package
Data

Gold partner £30,000

Includes: Gold level sponsorship rights and branding
6m x 5m stand
1 x keynote slot
2 x seminars (solo, workshop or arrange a panel)
1 x reception
Premium digital marketing package
Data

Silver partner £20,000

Includes: Silver level sponsorship rights and branding
6m x 3m stand
2 x seminars (solo, workshop or arrange a panel)
Digital marketing package
Data

Platinum partner £50,000

Includes: Platinum level sponsorship rights and branding
6m x 5m stand
2 x keynote slots
2 x seminar (solo, workshop or arrange a panel)
2 x receptions
Lead Digital marketing package
Data

Targeted brand activations

Registration question £15,000

Direct insight into attendee priorities, with contact data of respondents for structured follow-up.

Entrance sponsor £20,000

First impression ownership at the main visitor entry point.
Size (approx. 12m x 10m)

VIP & Green room £20,000

Private access to headline speakers and invited guests.

Lanyard sponsor £15,000

Your brand visible throughout both days across the entire audience.

Show bags sponsor £15,000

Direct physical brand placement with every attendee.

Central Cafe sponsor £25,000

Prominent positioning in one of the most consistently trafficked areas of the show floor

Connection Hub sponsor £15,000

Alignment with curated meet-ups and access to attendee data from hosted sessions.



Festival of Entrepreneurs

Contact details

For stand and sponsorship opportunities (including speakers from commercial vendors)

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For VIP Guest speaker and podcast opportunities

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For marketing and partnership enquiries

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